

AMBER X. CHEN

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara

PhD Candidate in Social Psychology

Thesis: *Contextualized Person Perception*, Advisor: Prof. Hongbo Yu

Sep 2022 - May 2027 (expected)

Santa Barbara, CA, USA

Master's in Computer Science

Thesis: *Multimodal Representation Learning for Social Knowledge*

Mar 2023 - May 2027 (expected)

The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Master's in Psychology

Thesis: *Motivation Impacts Emotion Recognition through Attentional Selection*, Advisor: Prof. Helene H. Fung

Nov 2017

Hong Kong SAR, China

Sun Yat-sen University

Bachelor's in Sociology

Thesis: *An Empirical Analysis of Chinese Social Class Schema Based on CLDS 2016*, Advisor: Prof. Yucheng Liang

Jun 2016

Guangdong, China

University of California, Berkeley

Exchange Student

Aug – Dec 2014

Berkeley, CA, U.S.A

PUBLICATIONS

Chen, A. X., Cao, R., Lin, C., Wang, S., & Yu, H. (in prep). A dual-route model of facial impressions: Dissociating the perceptual and conceptual contributions.

Chen, A. X.*, Cao, J.*, Mai, C.*, & Fung, H. H. (submitted). Age Bias in People's Daily Across 72 Years. doi: [10.31234/osf.io/2bf56](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/2bf56)

Zeng, J., Liu, S., Mai, C., **Chen, A. X.**, & Sun, Z. (submitted). A Study on the Formation of Age Stereotypes Based on Causal Inference: A Comparison of China and USA Cultures

Chen, A. X., Sun, S., & Yu, H. (2024). Moral attitudes towards effort and efficiency: A comparison between American and Chinese history. *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*, 11(1), 1–14. doi: [10.1057/s41599-024-03603-3](https://doi.org/10.1057/s41599-024-03603-3)

Mai, C., Chen, D., Olivos, F., & **Chen, A. X.** (2024). Disentangling Stereotypes towards Older Age Groups: Evidence from Factorial Survey Experiments in China and the USA. *Gerontology*, 70(2), 210–234. doi: [10.1159/000534680](https://doi.org/10.1159/000534680)

Chen, Y., **Chen, A. X.**, Yu, H., & Sun, S. (2024). Unraveling moral and emotional discourses on social media: a study of three cases, *Information, Communication Society*, 27(7), 1295–1312. doi: [10.1080/1369118X.2023.2246551](https://doi.org/10.1080/1369118X.2023.2246551)

Galkin, F., Kochetov, K., Koldasbayeva, D., Fung, H. H., **Chen, A. X.**, & Zhavoronkov, A. (2022). Psychological factors substantially contribute to biological aging: Evidence from the aging rate in Chinese older adults. *Psychology and Aging*, 14(18), 7206–7222. doi: [10.1037/pag0000696](https://doi.org/10.1037/pag0000696)

Chen, A. X.*, Tsang, V. H. L.*, Wong, J. T. K.*, Fung, H. H., & Ayalon, L. (2020). Three Ways that Ageing Affects Women Differently from Men: Menopause, Changes in Physical Appearance and Caregiving. In *Cambridge Handbook of the International Psychology of Women*. Fanny M. Cheung & Diane F. Halpern. (Eds.), (pp. 124–136). Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. doi: [10.1017/9781108561716.012](https://doi.org/10.1017/9781108561716.012)

Fung, H. H., Chu, S. T. W., Jiang, D., **Chen, A. X.**, & Ng, C. C. (2020). Contrasting the Effects of Mortality Salience and Future Time Limitation on Goal Prioritization in Older and Younger Adults. *Journal of Gerontology: Psychological Sciences* 75(10), 2112–2121. doi: [10.1093/geronb/gbz133](https://doi.org/10.1093/geronb/gbz133)

*Co-first authors contributed equally to this work.

INVITED TALK

Invited Participant, *A Neurocomputational Framework for Mapping Social Relationships: Insights from EEG*. Bridging the Inter-Disciplinary Gap in the Mathematical Modeling of Social Phenomena Workshop. Banff International Research Station (BIRS), Alberta, Canada. November 2-7 2025

SELECTED CONFERENCES

- Chen, A. X.** & Yu, H. (2026, Apr 15 - 18). *Social Networks Shape How We Form Impressions*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Conference (SANS) 2026 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. San Diego, CA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.** & Yu, H. (2025, Apr 23 - 27). *A dual-route model of social trait perception from face: Dissociating the perceptual and conceptual contributions behaviorally and neurally*. Social and Affective Neuroscience Society Conference (SANS) 2025 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. Chicago, IL, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Cao, R., Wang, S., & Yu, H. (2024, February 7-10). *Contextualized Social Information Predicts Neuronal Representation of Social Traits Perceived from Faces*. Computational Psychology Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) 2024 Annual Convention [Oral Presentation]. San Diego, CA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Sun, S., & Yu, H. (2023, February 22-25). *Moralization of unproductive effort: Cross-cultural and historical analysis based on Natural Language Processing*. Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP) 2023 Annual Convention [Poster Presentation]. Atlanta, GA, USA.
- Chen, A. X.**, Lu, M., & Fung, H. H. (2022, March 30 - Apr 2). *Cultural differences in the prevalence and spread of emotional complexity on social media*. The Society for Affective Science (SAS) 2022 Annual Conference [Oral Presentation]. Online.
- Chen, A. X.**, & Fung, H. H. (2020, November 4-7). *Individualism increases the influence of perceived competence of older adults on attitudes toward them*. The Gerontological Society of America (GSA) Annual Scientific Meeting [Poster Presentation]. Online.
- Chen, A. X.**, Fung, H. H., & Liang, Y. (2019, October 3-5). *The instrumentality of emotion on social media: Self-relevance as a moderator in emotional sharing*. The 2019 Technology, Mind & Society Conference [Poster Presentation]. Washington, D.C., USA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Motivation and Emotion Laboratory, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Lab Manager

Sept 2017 – July 2022

- Managed research projects on cultural differences and emotions using psychophysiological techniques, experience sampling, and surveys; Supervised undergraduate research assistants

Center for Social Survey, Sun Yat-sen University

Research Assistant

May 2014 – Aug 2016

- Managed data collection for the Chinese Education Panel Survey (CEPS; 2014-2016).

RESEARCH GRANTS

ISBER Collaborative Research Initiative Grant

Jun 2022 - Dec 2023

Office of Research, UCSB

Project: The moralization of effort and efficiency through the lens of Natural Language Processing: A cross-culture and historical perspective

Role: Co-Investigator, Project Lead; Amount: USD 5,979

General Research Fund

Aug 2023 – Apr 2026

Research Grants Council of Hong Kong

Project: Age Differences in Information Spreading: A Social Network Perspective

Role: Co-Investigator, Led Facebook study and proposed social network manipulation ; Amount: HKD 1,042,719

Social Science Research Impact Fund

Jun 2021 – Feb 2023

Faculty Office of Social Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Project: Increasing preparation of ageing and decreasing negative age stereotypes by increasing self-relevance

Role: Co-Investigator, Led Weibo study; Amount: HKD 500,000

Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding

Aug 2021 – Apr 2022

Faculty Office of Social Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Project: Age stereotypes across time and the roles of self-relevance: A computational social science approach
Role: Principal Investigator; Amount: HKD 15,000

Research Grant

Jan 2021 – Apr 2021

Hong Kong Sociological Association

Project: Ageism Under the Covid-19 Pandemic and Its Cross-cultural Variations

Role: Co-Investigator; Amount: HKD 5,000

Interdisciplinary Research Seed Funding

Oct 2020 – Apr 2021

Faculty Office of Social Science, The Chinese University of Hong Kong

Project: Ageism Under the Covid-19 Pandemic and Its Cross-cultural Variations: A Computational Social Science Approach

Role: Principal Investigator; Amount: HKD 15,000

Tencent Anthropology Fieldwork Grant

Jun 2014 – Dec 2015

Tencent Research Institute, Tencent Holdings Ltd, China

Project: How Adolescents Adopt Different Perceptions of the Same Social Network: The Role of Network Position

Role: Principal Investigator; Amount: CNY 3,000

AWARDS AND HONORS

Individualized Professional Skills Grant, UCSB 2025

African and Asian Students in STEM Scholarship, UCSB 2025

The GSA Conference Travel Grant, UCSB 2023-25

Highlighted Poster Award, The 2019 Technology, Mind & Society, Washington, D.C., USA. 2019

Academic Excellence Scholarship (top 5%), School of Sociology and Anthropology, SYSU 2014 – 2015

Third Place Award at Survey Contest of Political Affairs, Guangdong Province 2014

Second Place Award at Social Investigation Contest of Social Issues, SYSU 2014

Outstanding Individual Scholarship, SYSU 2013 – 2014

PROFESSIONAL TRAINING

NeuroAI(Fully funded)

Jul 14 – 28 2025

Modules: task structure, microcircuitry, neural architecture, learning rules.

Neuromatch Academy

Konstanz School of Collective Behavior(Fully funded)

Jul 22 – Aug 9, 2024

Focuses: Modeling collective behaviors of animals and humans.

University of Konstanz, Germany

NeuroDataReHack (Accommodation funded)

Jul 8-12, 2024

Focuses: Collaborative neuroinformatics projects and data science. Howard Hughes Medical Institute, Virginia, USA

Certified Carpentries Instructor Training

Mar 2025

Courses: Carpentries Pedagogical Model, Build a Workshop Website, Participatory Live Coding

The Carpentries

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science

Jul – Aug 2016

Modules: Information Diffusion in Online Social Networks, Agent-based Social Simulation, etc.

SYSU

Summer Institute in Advanced Quantitative Methods (*Travel and accommodation funded*)

Jul 2014

Modules: Multilevel Modeling, Counterfactual Model of Causality, etc.

Xi'an Jiaotong University, China

TEACHING EXPERIENCES

Teaching Assistant, UCSB

Sep 2022 – Present

Computational Neuroscience (graduate level), Social Neuroscience, Research Methods, Statistical Methods, Social Psychology, Biopsychology

SKILLS

- Proficient in Natural Language Processing, Machine Learning, and Social Network Analysis
- Experienced in using PsychoPy, E-Prime, neuroimaging techniques, and eye-tracking techniques,
- Language and Software: Python, R, Matlab, Stata, and SPSS; FSL and Workbench

COMMUNITY SERVICES

Reviewer, Motivation and Emotion; Humanities and Social Sciences Communications; BMC Geriatrics; Discover Psychology 2026

Statistics Fellow, Department of Psychological and Brain Sciences, UCSB 2023/24

Creator of an open dataset directory *Social Neuroscience DataFinder* 2026

Coordinator of Journal Club *ReproducibiliTea* 2023-2025

Co-Founder & Metnor, PsyCN2None for Graduate Application

Chenxi Liu, University of Arizona; Xiao Hu, SYSU 2025/26

Qingyi Li, Virginia Tech; Ying Ye, U Melbourne; Jing Chen, Virginia Tech; Yinbo Zheng, U Georgia 2024/25

Yichen Wang, Cornell; Kun Wang, Baylor University; Weifang Huang, Boston College; Leyi Zhuang, CUHK 2023/24

Junsong Lu, UCSD; Lyu Meng, Boston College; Yilin Kou, The Hong Kong Polytechnic University 2022/23